

**VISVESVARAYATECHNOLOGICAL UNIVERSITY
BELAGAVI – 590018, KARNATAKA**



**REPORT ON YOGA
(21YO83)**

Submitted in the partial fulfilment of requirement for the award of Degree of
Bachelor of Engineering
in
Computer Science & Engineering

**Submitted
by
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4BD21CS020**



**Bapuji Educational Association®
Bapuji Institute of Engineering and Technology, Davangere.
Department of Computer Science & Engineering**

2024-2025

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CERTIFICATE

This is to certify that **Anushree B Kuppast** bearing USN **4BD21CS020** has satisfactorily completed the Yoga Activity. This report of the activities has been approved as it satisfies the academic requirements in respect of the activities prescribed for the academic year 2022-2025 in partial fulfillment of the requirements for the award of the degree of Bachelor of **COMPUTER SCIENCE & ENGINEERING**, of VTU Belagavi, during the year 2022-2025.

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Department of Computer Science & Engineering

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Mission of the Institute

BIET contributes to the growth and development of its students by imparting a broad-based engineering education and empowering them to be successful in their chosen field by inculcating in them positive approach, leadership qualities and ethical values.

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Mission of Department

M1. Adapting best teaching and learning techniques that cultivates Questioning and Reasoning culture among the students.

M2. Creating collaborative learning environment that ignites the critical thinking in students and leading to the innovation.

M3. Establishing Industry Institute relationship to bridge the skill gap and make them industry ready and relevant.

M4. Mentoring students to be socially responsible by inculcating ethical and moral values.

Course Learning Objectives:

- Understand the Meaning and Importance of the Fit India Movement, the Definition of fitness, Benefits of fitness, Types of fitness, and Fitness tips.
- Importance of Sports & Yoga in day-to-day life.
- National Service Scheme (NSS) will enable the students to: Understand the community in which they work identify the needs and problems of the community and involve them in problem-solving.
- Develop among themselves a sense of social & and civic responsibility & and utilize their knowledge in finding practical solutions to individual and community problems.

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4BD21CS020

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COURSE OUTCOMES

CHAPTER 1

WORK CARRIED OUT IN THIRD SEMESTER

1.1 INTRODUCTION TO YOGA

Yoga is a holistic discipline that originated in ancient India, focusing on physical, mental, and spiritual well-being. Derived from the Sanskrit word "Yuj", meaning "to unite" or "to join," yoga symbolizes the union of the individual self with the universal consciousness. It is both a philosophy and a practical science of self-realization.

ORIGIN

Yoga traces its roots back over 5,000 years to the Indus-Sarasvati civilization in northern India. The earliest references to yoga are found in the Rigveda, a collection of ancient hymns. The practice was originally developed by sages and ascetics to achieve spiritual enlightenment and inner peace.

The Upanishads and Bhagavad Gita, ancient Indian scriptures, expanded on yoga's philosophical and practical aspects. Yoga was seen as a path to self-discovery and liberation.

HISTORY Pre-Classical Yoga (5000 BCE - 200 BCE)

The foundations of yoga were laid in the Vedic period, emphasizing rituals and meditation. The Upanishads introduced ideas of inner transformation and self-realization. The Bhagavad Gita presented yoga as a path of devotion (Bhakti), knowledge (Jnana), and action (Karma).

Modern Yoga (19th Century - Present)

Yoga was introduced to the West through influential figures like Swami Vivekananda and Paramahansa Yogananda.

AIM AND OBJECTIVES OF YOGA

The primary aim of yoga is to achieve **holistic well-being** by harmonizing the body, mind, and spirit. It seeks to promote self-realization, inner peace, and a connection with the universal consciousness.

OBJECTIVES OF YOGA 1. Physical Health and Well-being

- Enhance flexibility, strength, and balance.
- Improve overall physical fitness and immunity.

2. Mental Clarity and Emotional Stability

- Reduce stress, anxiety, and mental tension.
- Foster mindfulness, concentration, and emotional resilience.

3. Harmony with Nature

- Cultivate respect for the environment and natural surroundings.
- Align human life with universal laws.

IMPORTANCE OF PRAYER

Prayer holds a special place in yoga, as it complements the practice by fostering mental, emotional, and spiritual well-being. It serves as a bridge to align the practitioner with the higher self and universal energy.

1. **Spiritual Alignment:** Deepens the connection with the divine or universal consciousness. Enhances the spiritual aspect of yoga, moving beyond physical postures.
2. **Mental Clarity and Focus:** Prepares the mind for meditation by calming distractions. Cultivates mindfulness and a sense of purpose. Energy with the flow of the universe.
3. **Holistic Growth:** Complements yoga's aim of uniting body, mind, and spirit. Provides inspiration and motivation for consistent practice.

1.2 YOGIC PRACTICES FOR COMMON MAN

Yoga is a practical and accessible discipline designed to promote **positive health** and wellbeing for individuals of all ages and fitness levels. By integrating simple physical postures, breathing techniques, and relaxation practices, yoga offers a holistic approach to maintaining a healthy body and a calm mind. Key Yoga Practices for Positive Health

1. Asanas (Physical Postures):

- Tadasana (Mountain Pose): Improves posture and balance.
- Bhujangasana (Cobra Pose): Strengthens the back and relieves stress.
- Vrikshasana (Tree Pose): Enhances concentration and stability.

2. Pranayama (Breathing Techniques):

- Anulom Vilom (Alternate Nostril Breathing): Calms the mind and balances energy.
- Kapalabhati (Cleansing Breath): Improves lung capacity and detoxifies the body.

3. Dhyana (Meditation):

Reduces stress, enhances focus, and fosters emotional resilience.

4. Shavasana (Relaxation Pose):

Relieves fatigue and promotes deep relaxation.

1.3 RULES AND REGULATIONS

Some of the rules and regulations of yoga practise are:

1. A cotton cloth having good length and breadth should be used for doing Yoga practice.
2. Sit in the direction of east or north in the cotton cloth start the yoga from prayer to all Yoga Practices.
3. Yoga practice is best in the morning, after a bath, and can be done in the evening before sunset for those unable to practice in the morning.
4. Yoga requires a clean, well-lit, and quiet space with minimal clutter, free from noise and distractions, to maintain a pleasant atmosphere throughout the practice.
5. Practice yoga without banyan, spectacles, or watch. Use underwear for men and churidar or pajamas for women, ensuring chest and hips aren't tight.
6. Avoid using fans or air-conditioned rooms during yoga practice, but adjust this rule slightly based on seasonal changes.
7. Practice begins with a prayer, followed by 2 minutes of meditation to remove stress and tension, requiring high concentration.
8. After meditation, stay in Shavasana position for body strain removal, then start yoga practice. Sit silent for stress removal, then enjoy a bath and breakfast.
9. Yoga should only be practiced after a doctor's or teacher's prescription, focusing on soft body softness and not using strength or games. Daily practice is recommended for optimal results.
10. Yoga practice should be focused, with no interruptions. It's essential for a healthy body, so dedicate an hour daily and avoid bans without serious reasons.

1.4 MISCONCEPTIONS OF YOGA

Yoga is an ancient practice that originated in India, focusing on the union of the mind, body, and spirit. It includes physical postures (asanas), breathing exercises (pranayama), and meditation (dhyana) to promote overall well-being. Many people associate yoga solely with flexibility, but it also enhances strength, balance, and mental clarity. Despite its numerous benefits, several misconceptions surround yoga.

Many also mistake yoga for just a form of physical exercise, overlooking its deep mental and emotional benefits. Additionally, some think that special equipment is necessary, but yoga can be practiced anywhere with minimal resources. By dispelling these misconceptions, more people can appreciate the holistic benefits of yoga and incorporate it into their daily lives.

Aspect	Yogic Practices	Non-Yogic Practices
Objective	Focus on holistic well-being (physical, mental, and spiritual).	Primarily focus on physical or material benefits.
Approach	Combines postures, breath control, meditation, and ethical principles.	Involves activities like sports, gym workouts, or other exercises.
Mind-Body Connection	Emphasizes mindfulness and inner awareness.	Often focuses on physical effort with less emphasis on mental integration.
Spiritual Aspect	Aims for self-realization and spiritual growth.	Does not typically address spiritual development.
Breathing Techniques	Involves controlled and rhythmic breathing (pranayama).	Breathing is usually natural and unregulated.
Pace and Intensity	Slow, steady, and mindful movements.	Can be fast-paced or intense, depending on the activity.
Tools Required	Requires minimal equipment, often just a mat.	May require specific tools or equipment.
Long-Term Impact	Promotes sustained well-being, balance, and inner peace.	Primarily improves physical fitness or performance.

Figure 1: Difference Between Yogic and Non-Yogic Practices

1.5 SURYNAMASKARA

Suryanamaskara, or Sun Salutation, is a traditional yoga practice that consists of a sequence of 12 postures performed in a continuous flow. Before beginning, many practitioners chant the Suryanamaskara Mantra, which consists of 12 names of the Sun God (Surya), expressing gratitude and seeking strength, energy, and vitality. Each mantra corresponds to a posture and invokes different attributes of the Sun, such as wisdom, health, and power. The prayer symbolizes paying respect to the source of all life and harnessing solar energy for overall well-being.

Importance of Suryanamaskara: Suryanamaskara holds great significance in yoga and Indian tradition. It is considered a complete workout that integrates movement, breath control, and mindfulness. It aligns the body's energy with nature's rhythm, making it a powerful practice for physical and spiritual growth. Regular practice is believed to enhance concentration, discipline, and a deep connection with the self.

Benefits of Suryanamaskara: Practicing Suryanamaskara daily offers numerous benefits for the body and mind. It improves flexibility, strengthens muscles, and enhances cardiovascular health. The rhythmic breathing involved boosts lung capacity and oxygen supply, increasing overall vitality. It also aids in weight management, improves digestion,

and stimulates blood circulation. On a mental level, it reduces stress, promotes mental clarity, and enhances emotional stability.

1.6 DIFFERENT TYPES OF ASANAS

a. SITTING: PADMASANA (Lotus Pose)

Padmasana, also known as the Lotus Pose, is a classic meditative posture in yoga that promotes physical stability and mental calmness. To perform Padmasana, sit on a yoga mat with your legs stretched forward. Bend the right knee and place the right foot on the left thigh with the sole facing upward and the heel close to the abdomen. Repeat the same with the left leg, placing the left foot on the right thigh, ensuring both soles face upward. Keep the spine straight, shoulders relaxed, and hands resting on the knees in Gyan Mudra or with palms facing upward. Close your eyes and focus on steady, deep breaths. This pose enhances hip flexibility, strengthens pelvic muscles, calms the mind, and promotes proper posture. It is also believed to activate the chakras, aiding in the flow of energy throughout the body. However, it is essential to practice Padmasana with caution, especially for those with knee or ankle injuries. Beginners can use a cushion under the hips for added support and gradually increase the duration of holding the pose as their flexibility improves.

Importance of Padmasana:

Spiritual Significance: The lotus symbolizes purity and enlightenment. Sitting in Padmasana is believed to facilitate energy flow through the chakras, especially the Muladhara (Root) and Sahasrara (Crown) chakras, promoting spiritual growth.

Meditative Stability: The crossed-leg position creates a solid base, helping practitioners maintain an erect spine and a balanced posture, which is crucial for deep meditation.

1. **Mind-Body Connection:** It fosters a harmonious connection between body and mind by synchronizing breath and posture, thus deepening focus and awareness.
2. **Physical and Mental Balance:** By equally distributing the body's weight, it helps in grounding and centering the practitioner, reducing restlessness.

Benefits of Padmasana:

1. **Improves Flexibility:** Regular practice enhances hip and knee flexibility, gradually opening the pelvic region.
2. **Strengthens the Spine:** Maintaining an upright posture strengthens the spinal muscles and promotes proper alignment.

3. **Reduces Stress and Anxiety:** The meditative aspect of the pose activates the parasympathetic nervous system, promoting relaxation and reducing stress levels.
4. **Boosts Circulation:** Sitting cross-legged improves blood circulation in the lower limbs and pelvic area.
5. **Enhances Joint Health:** The pose keeps the knees and ankles flexible, reducing stiffness over time.
6. **Improves Digestion:** The posture stimulates abdominal organs, aiding in better digestion and reducing discomfort.
7. **Stabilizes the Mind:** By fostering mindfulness and concentration, it helps in reducing anxiety and cultivating inner peace.
8. **Promotes Mental Clarity:** Practicing Padmasana regularly helps in calming the nervous system, which can lead to enhanced clarity and mental focus.



Fig 2: Padmasana

b. VAJRASANA (Thunderbolt Pose):

Vajrasana (Thunderbolt Pose) is a simple yet powerful kneeling yoga posture that is highly beneficial for digestion and mental relaxation. To practice Vajrasana, kneel down with your knees close together and your big toes touching, then sit back on your heels with your buttocks resting on the heels and your spine straight. Keep your hands on your knees with palms facing down, close your eyes, and focus on slow, deep breaths. This pose can be held for 5 to 10 minutes or longer, gradually increasing the duration over time.

Vajrasana is the only yoga posture that can be performed immediately after meals as it enhances digestion by improving blood circulation to the abdominal region. It helps alleviate constipation, acidity, and indigestion, making it highly beneficial for gastrointestinal health. This pose also strengthens the lower back, tones the pelvic muscles, and improves posture. Additionally, it promotes mental calmness and reduces stress and anxiety by enhancing focus and mindfulness. Practicing Vajrasana regularly

can also aid in managing lower back pain and sciatica, making it an effective posture for overall physical and mental well-being.



Fig 3. Vajrasana

c. STANDING: VRIKSHASANA (Tree Pose)

Vrikshasana is a balancing yoga posture that resembles the steady stance of a tree. It involves standing on one leg while the other foot is placed on the inner thigh of the standing leg, with hands joined overhead. To practice Vrikshasana, stand straight with your feet together and shift your weight onto the left leg. Bend your right knee and place the sole of your right foot on the inner thigh of your left leg. Keep your spine straight, join your palms in a prayer position overhead, and gaze at a fixed point to maintain balance. Hold the pose for 30 seconds to 1 minute, then switch sides.

Importance of Vrikshasana:

1. **Enhances Balance and Stability:** Vrikshasana helps in developing physical balance by training the body to maintain stability while standing on one leg, thus improving overall coordination.
2. **Strengthens Legs and Ankles:** This pose engages the leg muscles, particularly the thighs, calves, and ankles, promoting muscle endurance and preventing leg injuries.
3. **Improves Posture and Spine Alignment:** By keeping the spine elongated and upright, Vrikshasana corrects posture and helps alleviate back pain caused by poor alignment.
4. **Boosts Concentration and Focus:** Maintaining balance in this pose requires mental focus and concentration, enhancing cognitive function and promoting mental clarity.
5. **Calms the Mind and Reduces Stress:** The steady, grounded nature of the posture helps in calming the mind, reducing anxiety, and relieving stress.

6. **Increases Hip Flexibility:** Vrikshasana opens up the hips, improving flexibility and relieving stiffness in the hip joints.
7. **Enhances Self-Confidence and Body Awareness:** Holding the pose with a steady gaze fosters a sense of self-assurance and body awareness, cultivating inner stability and self-control.



Fig 4. Vrikshasana

d. TRIKONASANA (Triangle Pose)

Trikonasana (Triangle Pose) is a standing yoga posture that stretches and strengthens various muscle groups while improving overall body alignment. To perform Trikonasana, stand with your feet about 3-4 feet apart. Turn your right foot outward at a 90° angle and your left foot slightly inward. Inhale and raise your arms parallel to the floor, keeping them in line with your shoulders. Exhale and bend your torso to the right, lowering your right hand to touch your shin, ankle, or the floor, while extending your left arm straight up. Keep your gaze fixed on the left hand and maintain the pose for 30-60 seconds. Repeat on the other side.

Importance and Benefits:

1. **Improves Flexibility and Balance:** Trikonasana stretches the legs, hips, and spine, enhancing flexibility and promoting better body alignment.
2. **Strengthens Legs and Core:** The pose engages the leg muscles, core, and lower back, building strength and stability.
3. **Alleviates Back Pain:** By lengthening the spine and releasing tension in the lower back, Trikonasana helps relieve back pain and stiffness.
4. **Stimulates Digestion:** The twisting motion stimulates abdominal organs, aiding digestion and reducing constipation.
5. **Enhances Mental Focus:** Maintaining balance and alignment in this pose improves concentration and focus.

6. **Opens the Chest and Shoulders:** It expands the chest and shoulders, increasing lung capacity and promoting deeper breathing.
7. **Relieves Stress and Anxiety:** The grounding nature of the pose helps calm the mind and alleviate stress and anxiety.

Regular practice of Trikonasana not only enhances physical strength and flexibility but also promotes mental clarity and inner balance.



Fig 5. Trikonasana

e. PRONE LINE: BHUJANGASANA (Cobra Pose)

Bhujangasana (Cobra Pose) is a prone back-bending yoga posture that resembles a cobra with its hood raised. To perform Bhujangasana, lie flat on your stomach with your legs extended and feet together, toes pointing outward. Place your palms under your shoulders with elbows close to your body. Inhale deeply and lift your chest off the floor, gently arching your back while keeping your pelvis and lower abdomen grounded. Keep your shoulders relaxed and gaze upward. Hold the pose for 15-30 seconds, breathing steadily. Exhale and slowly release to return to the starting position.

Importance of Bhujangasana (Cobra Pose):

1. **Strengthens the Spine:** Bhujangasana effectively engages the spinal muscles, promoting spinal flexibility and reducing the risk of back injuries.
2. **Improves Posture:** By stretching the chest and shoulders, it helps correct poor posture and aligns the spine properly.
3. **Enhances Lung Capacity:** The deep chest expansion in this pose increases lung capacity and promotes better breathing, beneficial for respiratory health.
4. **Stimulates Digestive System:** The gentle abdominal stretch stimulates digestive organs, aiding in digestion and relieving constipation.
5. **Alleviates Stress and Fatigue:** The backbend opens the heart area, releasing emotional tension and reducing stress and fatigue.

6. **Relieves Sciatica and Lower Back Pain:** The backward stretch helps decompress the lower back, alleviating sciatica pain and reducing lumbar discomfort.
7. **Improves Blood Circulation:** The pose increases blood flow to the spine, brain, and heart, enhancing overall circulation and energizing the body.

Benefits of Bhujangasana (Cobra Pose):

1. **Strengthens the Back and Spine:** Engages and tones the spinal muscles, improving spinal flexibility and preventing back pain.
2. **Enhances Posture:** Corrects slouching by opening the chest and shoulders, aligning the spine, and promoting an upright posture.
3. **Improves Digestion:** The abdominal stretch stimulates digestive organs, aiding in digestion and relieving constipation.
4. **Reduces Stress and Anxiety:** Opens the heart and chest, releasing emotional tension, calming the mind, and reducing stress.
5. **Relieves Sciatica and Lower Back Pain:** Stretches the lower back, alleviating sciatica discomfort and lumbar pain.
6. **Boosts Lung Capacity:** Expands the chest and lungs, increasing respiratory efficiency and promoting deeper breathing.
7. **Improves Circulation:** Enhances blood flow to vital organs, revitalizing the body and promoting overall health.
8. **Stimulates Reproductive Organs:** The gentle compression of the lower abdomen stimulates reproductive organs, aiding hormonal balance.
9. **Energizes the Body:** The backward stretch activates the adrenal glands, boosting energy levels and combating fatigue.



Fig 6: Bhujangasana

f. SHALABHASANA (Locust Pose)

Shalabhasana (Locust Pose) is a prone backbend yoga posture that strengthens the back, glutes, and legs while improving spinal flexibility. To practice Shalabhasana, lie flat on your stomach with your arms alongside your body and palms facing down. Keep your

legs together and chin resting on the mat. Inhale deeply, engage your core, and lift your chest, arms, and legs off the floor simultaneously. Keep the legs straight, toes pointed, and arms extended backward. Hold the pose for 15-30 seconds, breathing steadily. Exhale and slowly lower your body back to the mat.

Importance and Benefits:

1. **Strengthens the Back Muscles:** Shalabhasana effectively engages the lower back muscles, promoting spinal strength and stability.
2. **Improves Posture:** By strengthening the muscles along the spine, it helps in correcting poor posture and aligning the spine.
3. **Stimulates Abdominal Organs:** The pose massages and stimulates digestive organs, aiding in digestion and relieving constipation.
4. **Tones the Glutes and Legs:** The lift engages the glutes, hamstrings, and calves, enhancing muscle tone and endurance.
5. **Relieves Lower Back Pain:** The backward bend stretches and strengthens the lumbar region, reducing lower back discomfort.
6. **Improves Blood Circulation:** The pose encourages blood flow to the spine, pelvic region, and legs, revitalizing the body.
7. **Boosts Energy Levels:** The pose activates the adrenal glands, combating fatigue and promoting vitality.
8. **Enhances Concentration and Focus:** Maintaining the lift requires focus and stability, helping to improve mental clarity and concentration.



Fig 7: Shalabhasana

CHAPTER 2

WORK CARRIED OUT IN FOURTH SEMESTER

2.1 PATANJALI'S ASHTANGA YOGA

Patanjali's Ashtanga Yoga, often referred to as the "Eightfold Path," forms the cornerstone of yogic philosophy as outlined in the Yoga Sutras. This systematic approach provides a comprehensive framework for physical, mental, and spiritual well-being, guiding individuals toward self-realization and ultimate liberation (moksha). The eight limbs are Yama (ethical restraints), Niyama (personal disciplines), Asana (postures), Pranayama (breath control), Pratyahara (withdrawal of senses), Dharana (concentration), Dhyana (meditation), and Samadhi (absorption).

1. Yama: The First Limb of Patanjali's Ashtanga Yoga

Yama represents the ethical and moral guidelines in Patanjali's Ashtanga Yoga. These principles are universal disciplines meant to govern one's behaviour towards others and the environment. Yamas serve as the foundation for living a harmonious and righteous life. Some of them are:

- a. **Ahimsa (Non-Violence):** Ahimsa, a philosophy that promotes compassion, kindness, and respect for all life forms, aims to avoid harm in thought, word, and action.
- b. **Satya (Truthfulness):** Satya is the practice of honesty and truthfulness in all aspects of life, promoting alignment of thoughts, speech, and actions with the truth, while avoiding harm to others.
- c. **Asteya (Non-Stealing):** Asteya, or refraining from taking non-owned items, promotes contentment and integrity, reducing the desire to exploit others for personal gain.
- d. **Brahmacharya (Moderation/Celibacy):** Brahmacharya, traditionally referring to celibacy, promotes self-restraint, balance, and focus, directing energy towards spiritual growth and higher purposes, emphasizing moderation in all aspects of life.

Significance of Yamas: The Yamas, the ethical principles of a yogic lifestyle, promote inner peace, social harmony, and spiritual growth, fostering self-discipline and positive relationships for a balanced life.

2. Niyama: The Second Limb of Ashtanga Yoga

Niyama, the second limb of Patanjali's Ashtanga Yoga, focuses on self-discipline and personal growth. It provides guidelines for cultivating inner harmony and spiritual wellbeing. These principles are practices aimed at purifying the mind, body, and soul. The five Niyama are:

- a. **Shoucha (Cleanliness):** Shoucha symbolizes purity, promoting mental clarity, removing negativity, freshness, peace, and readiness for spiritual practices, promoting mental clarity and removing negativity.
- b. **Santosha (Contentment):** Santosha promotes acceptance and gratitude, fostering inner peace and reducing stress caused by desires and comparisons by focusing on contentment with one's possessions.
- c. **Tapa (Discipline):** Tapa signifies self-discipline and perseverance in the face of challenges. It involves training the mind and body through consistent effort and sacrifice to achieve higher goals. Tapa helps overcome laziness, distractions, and weaknesses, building strength and resilience.
- d. **Swadhyaya (Self-Study):** Swadhyaya is a spiritual practice that promotes introspection, self-reflection, and understanding through sacred texts, thoughts, and actions, fostering personal growth and divine connection.

Significance of Niyama: Niyama practices promote self-discipline, spiritual growth, inner strength, resilience, and contentment, harmonizing body, mind, and spirit, leading to a more fulfilling life.

2.2 SURYANAMASKARA

Surya Namaskar, or the Sun Salutation, is a series of twelve yoga poses performed in a sequence. It is both a physical exercise and a spiritual practice designed to pay homage to the sun, considered the source of all energy. Surya Namaskar promotes physical health, mental clarity, and spiritual growth, integrating movement, breath, and mindfulness.

Steps of Surya Namaskar

1. Pranamasana (Prayer Pose)
 - Posture: Stand upright with feet together, palms joined in front of the chest in a prayer position.
 - Benefits: Calms the mind, promotes focus, and prepares the body for the sequence.
2. Hasta Uttanasana (Raised Arms Pose)
 - Posture: Raise your arms above your head, stretching backward slightly.
 - Benefits: Stretches the abdomen and improves digestion; strengthens the spine.
3. Padahasthasana (Hand to Foot Pose)
 - Posture: Bend forward from the hips, keeping your back straight, and touch the floor with your hands near your feet.
 - Benefits: Enhances flexibility of the spine, stretches hamstrings, and stimulates blood flow.
4. Ashwa Sanchalanasana (Equestrian Pose)

- Posture: Extend your right leg back, place your hands on the floor, and look upward.
 - Benefits: Strengthens legs, improves balance, and stretches the hip flexors.
5. Dandasana (Stick Pose)
- Posture: Bring your left leg back to align with the right, forming a straight line from head to heels.
 - Benefits: Strengthens the arms, shoulders, and core muscles.
6. Ashtanga Namaskara (Salute with Eight Parts)
- Posture: Lower your chest, knees, and chin to the floor, keeping the hips slightly raised.
 - Benefits: Strengthens the chest, arms, and shoulders; enhances flexibility.
7. Bhujangasana (Cobra Pose)
- Posture: Raise your chest while keeping the legs and pelvis on the floor. Arch your back slightly and look upward.
 - Benefits: Improves spinal flexibility, strengthens the back, and stimulates abdominal organs.
8. Adho Mukha Svanasana (Downward Facing Dog Pose)
- Posture: Lift your hips and form an inverted "V" shape with your body. Keep your heels on the floor.
 - Benefits: Stretches the spine, shoulders, and legs; improves blood circulation to the brain.
9. Ashwa Sanchalanasana (Equestrian Pose)
- Posture: Bring your right foot forward between your hands and look upward.
 - Benefits: Same as Step 4.
10. Padahasthasana (Hand to Foot Pose)
- Posture: Bring your left foot forward and bend down, touching your feet.
 - Benefits: Same as Step 3.
11. Hasta Uttanasana (Raised Arms Pose)
- Posture: Rise up, stretch your arms overhead, and bend slightly backward. □
- Benefits: Same as Step 2.s
12. Pranamasana (Prayer Pose)
- Posture: Return to the starting position with palms joined at the chest.
 - Benefits: Same as Step 1.



Fig 8: Surya Namaskar

2.3 KAPALABHATI

Kapalabhati, derived from two Sanskrit words—"Kapala" meaning skull and "Bhati" meaning shining or illuminating—is a yogic cleansing technique (Shatkarma) and a form of Pranayama. It is often called "Skull Shining Breathing Technique" because it purifies the head region, enhances clarity, and brings a glow to the face. Kapalabhati involves forceful exhalation and passive inhalation, stimulating the respiratory and abdominal systems.

Importance of Kapalabhati

1. Detoxification: Kapalabhati is a cleansing kriya (Shatkarma) that expels toxins and impurities from the respiratory system and body.
2. Energy Booster: It revitalizes the body and mind, enhancing vitality and mental clarity.
3. Spiritual Connection: By activating the pranic energy (life force), Kapalabhati helps align the mind and body, preparing the practitioner for deeper meditative states.
4. Strengthening the Respiratory System: Regular practice improves lung capacity and efficiency, helping prevent respiratory illnesses.

Benefits of Kapalabhati

1. Physical Benefits:
 - Improved Digestion: Strengthens abdominal muscles, stimulates the digestive organs, and enhances metabolism.
 - Skin Health: Improves oxygen flow to the skin, giving it a natural glow.
2. Mental Benefits:

- Stress Relief: Calms the mind by focusing on rhythmic breathing.
 - Emotional Balance: Helps release suppressed emotions, leading to emotional stability.
3. Spiritual Benefits:
- Chakra Activation: Stimulates the Manipura Chakra (solar plexus), boosting confidence and willpower.
 - Pranic Energy: Promotes a free flow of prana (vital energy) throughout the body.

2.4 PRANAYAMA

Pranayama is a vital aspect of yoga, focusing on the regulation of breath to control the flow of prana, or life energy, within the body. Derived from the Sanskrit words "Prana" (life force) and "Ayama" (extension or control), pranayama involves a series of techniques that include controlled inhalation, exhalation, and retention of breath.

Need and Importance of Pranayama

In today's fast-paced world, stress, anxiety, and lifestyle disorders are prevalent. Pranayama is crucial as it helps calm the mind, improve focus, and enhance overall health. It oxygenates the body, detoxifies the system, and regulates the autonomic nervous system.

Types of Pranayama:

1. Nadi Shodhana (Alternate Nostril Breathing)

- Meaning: "Nadi" refers to energy channels, and "Shodhana" means cleansing. This pranayama purifies the energy pathways.
- Benefits: Improves focus, calms the mind, balances energy, and reduces stress.

2. Kapalabhati (Skull Shining Breath)

- Meaning: "Kapala" means skull, and "Bhati" means shining or illuminating.
- Benefits: Detoxifies the body, strengthens the lungs and abdomen, improves digestion, and enhances mental clarity.

3. Anuloma Villoma (Alternate Nostril Breathing)

- Meaning: "Anuloma" means with the grain, and "Villoma" means against the grain.
- Benefits: Enhances respiratory efficiency, reduces anxiety, balances the nervous system, and promotes relaxation.

4. Sheetali (Cooling Breath)

- Meaning: "Sheetali" means cooling, as this technique cools the body and mind.
- Benefits: Reduces body heat, alleviates stress, and improves digestion.

CHAPTER 3

WORK CARRIED OUT IN FIFTH SEMESTER

3.1 ASHTANGA YOGA

Ashtanga, derived from Sanskrit words Ashta and Anga, refers to the union of the eight limbs of yoga into a holistic system. It focuses on integrating these limbs, including Yama (moral codes), Niyama (self-discipline), Asana (posture), Pranayama (breath control), Pratyahara (sense withdrawal), Dharana (concentration), Dhyana (meditation) and Samadhi (Transcendental state).

3.2 SURYANAMASKARA

Surya Namaskar, or Sun Salutation, is an ancient practice that remains one of the most popular and versatile sequences in yoga. An ancient series of 12 asanas, which aims to energize the body, calm the mind, and connect practitioners with nature's rhythm.

1. **Pranamasana (Prayer Pose):** The sequence begins with Pranamasana, where the practitioner stands tall with feet together, palms joined in a prayer position at the chest.

Benefits:

- Helps center the mind and prepare the body for the sequence.
- Encourages the practitioner to cultivate gratitude and inner peace.

2. **Hasta Uttanasana (Raised Arms Pose):** In Hasta Uttanasana, the practitioner raises their arms above their head while arching the back slightly.

Benefits:

- Stretches and tones the abdominal muscles.
- Enhances lung capacity and strengthens the respiratory system.

3. **Padahasthasana (Standing Forward Bend Pose):** In Padahasthasana, the practitioner folds forward from the hips, bringing the hands down toward the feet.

Benefits:

- Stretches the hamstrings, calves, and spine.
- Relieves tension and stress in the neck and shoulders.

4. **Ashwa Sanchalanasana (Equestrian Pose):** Ashwa Sanchalanasana involves stepping one foot back into a deep lunge, opening the chest, and gazing forward.

Benefits:

- Stretches the hips, groin, and quadriceps.
- Strengthens the legs and improves balance.
- Enhances focus and concentration.

5. **Dandasana (Stick Pose):** Dandasana, or the plank pose, is a straight-line position that engages the core muscles.

Benefits:

- Strengthens the arms, shoulders, and core muscles.
- Improves posture and body alignment.

6. **Ashtanga Namaskara (Eight Limbed Pose):** In Ashtanga Namaskara, the practitioner lowers their body to the floor, touching the chin, chest, and knees while keeping the hips lifted.

Benefits:

- Strengthens the chest, arms, and spine.
- Promotes flexibility in the neck and shoulders.

7. **Bhujangasana (Cobra Pose):** Bhujangasana is a gentle backbend that opens the chest and stretches the spine.

Benefits:

- Improves spinal flexibility and strength.
- Stimulates the abdominal organs, promoting better digestion.

8. **Adho Mukha Svanasana (Downward Facing Dog Pose):** Adho Mukha Svanasana involves lifting the hips upward to form an inverted “V” shape, with the head between the arms.

Benefits:

- Stretches the hamstrings, calves, and spine.
- Relieves tension in the back and energizes the body.

9. **Ashwa Sanchalanasana (Equestrian Pose, Repeated on the Opposite Side):** The sequence repeats Ashwa Sanchalanasana, this time with the opposite leg stepping forward.

Benefits:

- Balances both sides of the body by repeating the pose with the opposite leg.
- Continues to stretch the hip flexors and quadriceps.

10. **Padahasthasana (Standing Forward Bend Pose, Repeated)1:**

The practitioner moves back into Padahasthasana, bending forward at the hips.

Benefits:

- Maintains flexibility in the spine and hamstrings.
- Promotes mental relaxation and focus.
- Enhances blood circulation and energizes the body.

11. Hasta Uttanasana (Raised Arms Pose, Repeated): The sequence transitions back into Hasta Uttanasana, with the practitioner stretching upward.

Benefits:

- Continues to stretch and lengthen the spine.
- Promotes a sense of vitality and well-being.

12. Pranamasana (Prayer Pose, Repeated): The sequence concludes with Pranamasana, bringing the practitioner back to a centered and peaceful state.

Benefits:

- Encourages mindfulness and inner calm.
- Promotes a sense of gratitude and balance.

3.3 DIFFERENT TYPES OF ASANAS

a. SITTING

1. ARDHA USHTRASANA

Ardha Ustrasana (Half Camel Pose) is a beginner-friendly backbend that gently stretches the chest, shoulders, and spine while strengthening the lower back. To practice Ardha Ustrasana, kneel on the mat with your knees hip-width apart and your spine straight. Keep your toes tucked under for stability. Place your left hand on your left heel or lower back while raising your right arm overhead. Inhale deeply and gently arch your back, leaning slightly backward. Keep your gaze upward and hold the pose for 15-30 seconds. Exhale and return to the starting position, then repeat on the other side.

2. VAKRASANA

Vakrasana (Twisted Pose) is a seated yoga asana that involves a gentle spinal twist, which is highly beneficial for improving flexibility, digestion, and detoxification. To perform Vakrasana, sit on the floor with your legs extended straight in front of you. Bend your right knee and place your right foot flat on the floor next to your left knee. With an inhale, lengthen your spine, and as you exhale, twist your torso to the right. Place your left elbow on the outside of your right knee, while your right hand rests behind you for support. Keep your shoulders relaxed and maintain a straight spine throughout the twist. Hold the position for 15-30 seconds, focusing on deep, steady breathing, then slowly return to the starting position and repeat the twist on the other side.

This asana provides a deep stretch for the spine and helps in releasing stiffness in the back. It stimulates the abdominal organs, promoting better digestion, reducing bloating, and improving the elimination process. Vakrasana also aids in detoxification by massaging internal organs, particularly the liver and kidneys. The pose strengthens the

core muscles and improves posture, while also offering stress relief. By practicing Vakrasana regularly, one can experience better spinal health, enhanced digestion, and improved mental clarity.

b. STANDING

1. URDHVA HASTOTHANASANA

2. HASTAPADASANA

Urdhva Hastothanasana (Upward Salute Pose) is a standing yoga asana that stretches the body, particularly the arms, shoulders, and back, while improving posture and flexibility. To perform this pose, start by standing tall with your feet hip-width apart. Inhale deeply and raise your arms overhead, keeping your palms facing each other. Stretch your arms upward, lengthening your spine, and gaze forward or slightly upward, relaxing your neck. Hold the pose for several breaths, then exhale and gently lower your arms back down.

This pose enhances posture by encouraging a straight spine and proper alignment. It stretches and releases tension in the arms, shoulders, and upper back, improving flexibility. Urdhva Hastothanasana also strengthens the core, tones abdominal muscles, and helps relieve stress by promoting relaxation. Additionally, it stimulates better circulation and encourages mindful breathing, benefiting overall lung capacity. Regular practice of this pose increases physical strength, mental clarity, and emotional balance.

C. PRONE LINE

1. PADANGUSHTA DHANURASANA

Padangushta Dhanurasana (Toe Wheel Pose) is a variation of the traditional Dhanurasana (Bow Pose) that combines a deep backbend with a toe grip, enhancing the stretch in the legs, hips, and spine. To perform Padangushta Dhanurasana, begin by lying flat on your stomach with your legs extended and feet hip-width apart. Bend your knees, bringing your heels toward your buttocks. Reach back with both hands and grip your big toes with your index and middle fingers. Inhale, and as you exhale, lift your chest and thighs off the floor, pulling on your toes to deepen the stretch in the back. Keep your gaze forward or slightly upward, ensuring your spine remains long and your chest is lifted. Hold the pose for 15-30 seconds, breathing deeply, then slowly release and lower your body back to the mat.

D. SUPINE LINE

1. SARVANGASANA

Sarvangasana (Shoulder Stand Pose) is an inverted yoga asana that offers numerous benefits for the body and mind. To perform Sarvangasana, begin by lying flat on your back with your arms at your sides and legs extended. Inhale, bend your knees, and bring them toward your chest. Press your palms into the floor for support, then lift your legs, hips, and torso upward, bringing your body into a vertical line. Support your lower back with your hands and keep your elbows close to the floor. Ensure your head, neck, and spine remain aligned. Your body should be balanced on your shoulders, and your feet should point directly upward. Hold the position for 30 seconds to 1 minute, focusing on steady breathing, then gently lower your legs back to the floor.

2. CHAKRASANA

Chakrasana (Wheel Pose), also known as **Urdhva Dhanurasana (Upward Bow Pose)**, is an advanced backbend that opens up the chest, strengthens the arms, and enhances flexibility in the spine. To perform Chakrasana, begin by lying on your back with your knees bent and feet flat on the floor, hip-width apart. Place your hands beside your ears with your fingers pointing towards your shoulders. Press your feet into the floor and, as you inhale, lift your hips up toward the ceiling, rolling your body onto the crown of your head. Then, with an exhale, press into your hands and feet to lift your chest, straightening your arms and legs. The body should form a bridge-like shape with the chest lifted toward the sky and the head tilted slightly back. Hold the pose for 15-30 seconds, then slowly lower your body back to the mat.

3.4 KAPALABHATI

Kapalabhati is a basic breathing technique of yoga (Pranayama). It comprises short, powerful exhales and gentle inhales synch with abdominal movement. As you inhale deeply through both nostrils, expand the chest and abdomen. While exhaling, rapidly draw the abdomen back and expel the air out. Exhale will automatically be followed by a short inhale and then exhale as previously.

Benefits:

- Practicing kapalabhati strengthens respiratory muscles and increase lung capacity.
- The kapalabhati can energize your brain which will improve your concentration and memory.

3.5 PRANAYAMA

1. SURYA BHEDANA

Surya Bhedana or Surya Bhedi is a warming/energizing pranayama practiced in a seated meditation posture. Using Vishnu Mudra (hand gesture), you block the left nostril, inhale through the right, retain the breath for as long as you can, and block the right nostril to exhale through the left nostril. The same steps are repeated to perform forced right-nostril breathing.

Benefits:

- **Improves Cardiovascular Health:** This pranayama technique helps maintain a healthy heart and can be an adjunct to preventing cardiovascular ailments, especially when combined with a balanced lifestyle and diet.
- **Mental Alertness and Clarity:** Surya Bhedana Pranayama enhances focus and mental clarity, preparing the mind for meditation and higher cognitive functions.

2. UJJAYI

Ujjayi Pranayama, often referred to as the victorious breath, is a powerful technique in yoga. The term "Ujjayi" means "victory," symbolizing the liberation it offers from physical and mental bondage. This pranayama is a crucial aspect of the eight Kumbhakas in Hatha Yoga.

Benefits:

- **Fluid Retention:** Helps in reducing edema or dropsy.
- **Purification:** Assists in Ghatashudhi, the purification of the seven dhatus (elements) – skin, flesh, blood, bones, marrow, fat, and semen.
- **Voice Enrichment:** Enhances the quality of the voice.

Limitations: Avoid practicing Ujjayi Pranayama if you have serious cardiac or hypertension issues. It can be done without breath retention if needed.

CHAPTER 4

WORK CARRIED IN SIXTH SEMESTER

4.1 ASHTANGA YOGA

1. PRATYAHARA

Pratyahara, the fifth limb of Ashtanga Yoga, involves withdrawing senses from external distractions, calming the mind, enhancing focus, and preparing for meditation.

Benefits are: Deepens meditation, increases focus and awareness, reduces stress and anxiety, enhances willpower, balances energy flow and boots emotional stability.

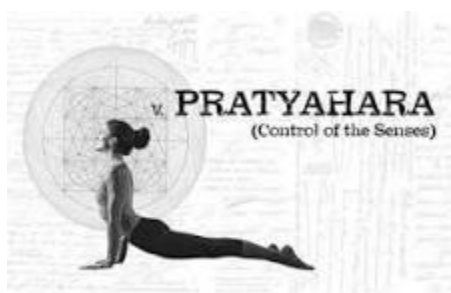


Fig 8: Pratyahara

2. DHARANA

Dharana, the sixth of the Eight Limbs of Yoga, involves mind concentration by focusing on an external or internal object. Ashtanga yoga consists of three limbs: dharana, dhyana (meditation), and samadhi (enlightenment).

Dharana involves binding attention to multiple spots, leading to total concentration. Dhyana is the next stage, followed by samadhi, the deepest concentration. To practice dharana, choose a calm place and position, with eyes closed or open. Yoga helps master dharana by improving focus, calmness, and mental strength.

4.2 DIFFERENT TYPES OF ASANAS

a. SITTING

1. Akarna Dhanurasana:

Akarna Dhanurasana:

ChatGPT said:

Akarna Dhanurasana (Archer Pose) is a dynamic and powerful yoga asana that strengthens the legs, core, and arms while enhancing flexibility in the hips and shoulders. The pose mimics the action of drawing a bow and is excellent for improving concentration,

stability, and balance. To perform Akarna Dhanurasana, begin by sitting on the floor with your legs extended in front of you. Bend your right knee and bring your right foot toward your chest, holding the big toe with your right hand. With your left hand, hold the imaginary bowstring by placing it above your left foot, as if you are preparing to shoot an arrow. Exhale and gently lean back, balancing on your sit bones, and then draw your arms apart as if pulling back a bow. Hold the pose for a few breaths while maintaining balance, then slowly release and switch sides.

2. Yogamudra in Padmasana:

Yogamudra in Padmasana is a meditative yoga pose that combines the Yogamudra hand gesture with the seated posture of Padmasana (Lotus Pose). This posture is primarily used for meditation and pranayama (breathing exercises) and is known for calming the mind, improving focus, and enhancing the flow of energy in the body.

How to Perform Yogamudra in Padmasana:

1. Sit in Padmasana (Lotus Pose): Begin by sitting on the floor with your legs crossed. Bring each foot to rest on the opposite thigh, keeping your back straight and your body centered.
2. Hand Gesture (Mudra): With your left hand, form a fist by curling your fingers and placing your thumb outside the fist. Then, place the fist on the palm of your right hand, with the right hand facing upward. Bring the hands in front of your chest, forming the Yogamudra gesture.
3. Positioning: Rest your hands comfortably on your lap with your palms facing upward and your fingers in the mudra. Keep your spine erect and shoulders relaxed.
4. Breathing: Close your eyes and begin to focus on your breath, breathing deeply and steadily. Maintain a calm, meditative state.

b. STANDING

1. Parivritta Trikonasana:

Parivritta Trikonasana (Revolved Triangle Pose) is a standing yoga asana that combines a deep twist with a lateral stretch, offering benefits for flexibility, strength, and balance. It targets the legs, hips, spine, and shoulders, and promotes mental clarity and focus. To practice Parivritta Trikonasana, begin by standing with your feet wide apart. Turn your right foot outward 90 degrees and your left foot inward at a slight angle. Extend your arms parallel to the floor, palms facing down. Inhale, lengthen your spine, and as you exhale,

extend your torso over your right leg, placing your left hand on the floor or a block beside your right foot. Simultaneously, twist your torso and reach your right arm toward the sky, keeping your gaze on your right hand. Hold the position for several breaths, maintaining a steady breath and keeping your body aligned. To exit the pose, inhale and slowly rise, then repeat on the other side.



Fig 9: Parivritta Trikonasana

2. Utkatasana:

Utkatasana (Chair Pose) is a powerful standing yoga pose that strengthens the legs, core, and back while improving balance and endurance. The name "Utkatasana" comes from the Sanskrit word "Utkata," meaning "powerful" or "intense," reflecting the effort and energy required to hold the pose. It mimics the action of sitting in an imaginary chair, which engages various muscle groups. To practice Utkatasana, begin by standing with your feet together and your arms at your sides. Inhale, and as you exhale, bend your knees and lower your hips as if you're sitting back into a chair. Keep your thighs parallel to the ground, ensuring that your knees do not extend beyond your toes. Raise your arms overhead, keeping them shoulder-width apart, with your palms facing each other. Keep your spine straight, chest lifted, and gaze forward. Hold the pose for 15-30 seconds or longer, focusing on deep breathing, then slowly rise back to standing.



Fig 10: Utkatasana

C. PRONE LINE

1. Poorna Bhujangasana /Rajakapotasana:

Poorna Bhujangasana is an advanced variation of Bhujangasana (Cobra Pose), where the chest is lifted higher, creating a deeper backbend. To perform this pose, begin by lying flat on your stomach with your legs extended and your feet hip-width apart. Place your hands on the floor underneath your shoulders, elbows bent. Inhale, and press into your palms to lift your upper body off the floor, extending your arms while lifting your chest and abdomen. Keep your elbows slightly bent as you engage your back muscles. Ideally, in this advanced variation, the chest is lifted much higher than in the regular cobra, creating a full arch. Hold the pose for a few breaths before gently lowering your torso back to the mat.



Fig 11: Poorna Bhujangasana /Rajakapotasana

D.SUPINE LINE

1. Navasana / Noukasana:

Navasana (Boat Pose), also known as **Noukasana** in some traditions, is a core-strengthening yoga asana that engages the abdominal muscles, improves balance, and strengthens the spine. The name "Navasana" comes from the Sanskrit words "*Nava*" meaning "boat" and "*Asana*" meaning "pose," as the posture resembles a boat floating on water.

How to Perform Navasana:

- Begin by sitting on the floor with your legs extended straight in front of you and your feet hip-width apart. Keep your spine straight and engage your core muscles.
- Inhale and, as you exhale, lean back slightly while keeping your back straight.
- Lift your legs off the floor, keeping them straight and at about a 45-degree angle to the floor. Your feet should be flexed, with your toes pointing towards the sky.
- Extend your arms forward, parallel to the floor, with your palms facing each other. Your body should form a "V" shape, with your legs and torso creating the arms of the "V."



Fig 12: Navasana / Nourkasana

2. Pavanamuktasana:

Pavanamuktasana (Wind-Relieving Pose) is a gentle yet effective yoga asana that focuses on improving digestion, relieving gas and bloating, and stretching the lower back and hips. The name comes from the Sanskrit words "*Pavana*" meaning "wind," "*Mukta*" meaning "relieving," and "*Asana*" meaning "pose." It is called the Wind-Relieving Pose because it helps release trapped gas in the digestive system, offering relief from discomfort and promoting overall digestive health.

How to Perform Pavanamuktasana:

- Begin by lying flat on your back with your legs extended and your arms by your sides.
- Inhale deeply, and as you exhale, bend your right knee and bring it toward your chest. Clasp both hands around your knee, pulling it closer to your torso.
- Keep your left leg extended on the floor, and press the lower back gently into the floor to maintain alignment.



Fig 13: Pavanamuktasana

4.2 KAPALABHATI

Kapalabhati, or Skull Shining Breath, is a yoga breathing technique that promotes mental clarity and energy. It involves inhaling through the nose and exhaling forcefully, balancing the nervous system, and reducing stress. However, it should be practiced cautiously by those with respiratory issues or high blood pressure.

4.3 PRANAYAMA:

1. Sheetali:

Sheetali is a yogic breathing technique known for its cooling and calming effects on the body and mind. It is especially beneficial for reducing body heat, calming the mind, and alleviating stress.

Steps to Practice Sheetali Pranayama:

- Sit in a Comfortable Position:
- Form the Tube with the Tongue:
- Inhale Deeply Through the Tongue Tube:
- Close the Mouth and Hold the Breath:
- Exhale Slowly Through the Nostrils:
- Repeat the Cycle:



Fig 14: Sheetali

2.SHEEKTARI:

Sheetkari Pranayama (Hissing Breath) is a cooling yogic breathing technique that soothes the mind and reduces body heat. Sit comfortably with your spine straight and teeth lightly touching. Slightly part the lips and inhale through the gaps between the teeth, producing a hissing “SSSS” sound. Withdraw the tongue, close the mouth, and exhale slowly through the nostrils. Repeat for 5–10 rounds.



Fig 15: Sheetkari

CHAPTER 5

WORK CARRIED OUT IN SEVENTH SEMESTER

5.1 ASHTANGA YOGA:

1.DHYANA (MEDITATION):

Dhyana, or Meditation, is a fundamental practice in yoga and spiritual traditions that focuses on achieving a deep state of mental clarity, stillness, and heightened awareness. It involves quieting the mind and turning inward, often by focusing on a specific object, sound, or the breath. It can also promote physical health by lowering blood pressure, boosting immunity, and improving sleep.



Fig 16: Dhyana

2.SAMADHI:

Samadhi is the ultimate stage of yoga, representing spiritual absorption and unity. It's the eighth limb of Patanjali's Eight Limbs of Yoga, requiring years of concentration and meditation. Achieving Samadhi brings liberation, freedom from suffering, and inner wisdom.



Fig 17: Samadhi

5.2 DIFFERENT TYPES OF ASANAS

a. SITTING

1. VIBHAKTA PASCHIMOTTANASANA:

Vibhakta Paschimottanasana (Separated Forward Bend Pose) involves sitting with

legs extended wide apart and bending forward from the hips. Begin by sitting with your spine straight and legs spread comfortably. Inhale, raise your arms, and lengthen the spine. Exhale and fold forward, reaching for your toes or ankles. Hold the pose for 5–10 breaths, feeling a deep stretch in the hamstrings, hips, and spine. This pose improves flexibility, stimulates blood circulation, and calms the mind.



Fig 18: Vibhakta Paschimottanasana

2. YOGAMUDRA IN VAJRANASANA

Yogamudra in Vajrasana (Yoga Seal in Thunderbolt Pose) combines the calming effect of Vajrasana with a forward bend to enhance inner focus. Sit in Vajrasana with your spine straight and hands resting on your knees. Inhale deeply and interlock your fingers behind your back. Exhale and slowly bend forward, bringing your forehead to the floor while raising your arms overhead. Hold for 5–10 breaths, feeling a deep stretch in the back, shoulders, and hips.



Fig 19: Yogamudra in Vajrasana

b. STANDING POSES

1. PARSHVAKONASANA

Parsvakonasana (Extended Side Angle Pose) is a standing yoga posture that strengthens the legs and stretches the sides of the body. Begin in Warrior II with the right knee bent at 90° and the left leg straight. Place the right hand on the floor outside the right foot or on a block, and extend the left arm overhead, forming a diagonal line from the left heel to

fingertips. Hold for 5–10 breaths, then repeat on the other side. This pose improves hip flexibility, strengthens the legs, and enhances spinal alignment while stimulating digestion and relieving tension.



Fig 20: Parsvakonasana

2. EKAPADA BADDHA PADMOTTANASANA

Ekapada Baddha Padmottanasana (One-Legged Bound Lotus Forward Bend) is a challenging yoga pose that combines balance, flexibility, and focus. Begin in a standing position and bring the right foot into a half-lotus position, placing it on the left thigh. Inhale, lengthen the spine, and exhale as you fold forward, reaching for the floor or holding the left ankle. Keep the hips square and the standing leg strong. Hold for 5–10 breaths, then repeat on the other side.



Fig 21: Ekapada Baddha Padmottanasana

c. PRONE LINE BALANCING

1. MAYURASANA:

Mayurasana (Peacock Pose) is an arm balance that strengthens the core, arms, and wrists while improving digestion. Begin in a kneeling position with your hands placed on the floor, fingers pointing backward. Bend the elbows and press them into the abdomen, just below the navel. Shift your body weight forward, lifting your legs off the ground, and balance with your body parallel to the floor. Keep the legs together and the core engaged.

Hold the pose for 5–10 breaths, then gently lower back down. This pose enhances focus, strengthens the arms, and stimulates the digestive system. Avoid if you have wrist or abdominal issues.



Fig 22: Mayurasana

d. SUPINE LINE

1. SARVANGASANA

Sarvangasana (Shoulder Stand) is an inverted yoga pose that strengthens the shoulders, arms, and core while promoting circulation. Start by lying on your back and lifting your legs overhead, bringing them close to the floor behind you. Use your hands to support your lower back as you raise your hips and legs vertically, ensuring your body is in a straight line. Keep your legs together and your feet pointed..



Fig 23: Sarvangasana

3. SETUBANDHASANA:

Setu Bandhasana (Bridge Pose) is a backbend that strengthens the back, glutes, and legs while opening the chest and hips. Begin by lying on your back with your knees bent and feet flat on the floor, hip-width apart. Place your arms by your sides, palms facing down. Press your feet into the ground as you lift your hips, creating a straight line from your shoulders to your knees. Clasp your hands under your back, interlacing your fingers. Hold the pose for 5–10 breaths, then slowly lower

your hips. This pose enhances spinal flexibility, improves circulation, and relieves stress.



Fig 24: Setubandhasana

4. SHAVASANA

Shavasana (Corpse Pose) is a deeply relaxing posture often practiced at the end of a yoga session to integrate the benefits of the practice. Begin by lying flat on your back with your legs extended and arms by your sides, palms facing upward. Keep your feet slightly apart and allow your body to relax completely. Close your eyes, focus on your breath, and release any tension in the body. Stay in this position for 5–15 minutes, allowing the mind and body to rest and rejuvenate.



Fig 24: Shavasana

5.3 PRANAYAMA

1. BHASTRIKA

Bhastrika is one of the eight traditional pranayamas. The name of this pranayama is taken from Sanskrit word bhastra which means bellows. The best thing about Bhastrika pranayama is that it lets one evolve the habit of equal breathing.

Benefits:

- Bhastrika Pranayama and Running improve lung function, particularly in athletes, swimmers, and dancers, by promoting insulin hormone secretion, treating Kapha dosha imbalance, and strengthening respiratory muscles.

- Slow Pace Bhastrika Pranayama is beneficial for oxygen deficiency, metabolism, digestion, weight loss, and blood pressure reduction in beginners, with immediate effects on blood pressure and heart rate.



Fig 25: Bhastrika

2. BHRAMARI

Bhramari word is made from the Hindi word “Bhramar” which means Bumble Bee and the meaning of Pranayama is breathing technique so it can also be called ‘bee breath’. Bhramari Pranayama edges in reducing high vital sign, fatigue, and mental stress.

Steps: Sit on a sitting Asana, close your eyes, breathe deeply, close your ears, place fingers above eyebrows, apply gentle pressure to nose, concentrate on eyebrow area, breathe out slowly, and make a humming sound of Om. Repeat this process five times, assuming connection to positive universe energies.



Fig 26: Bhramari

CHAPTER 6

WORK CARRIED IN EIGHTH SEMESTER

6.1 ASANAS

A. SITTING

1. BAKASANA

Bakasana (Crow Pose) is an arm-balancing posture that strengthens the arms, wrists, and core while improving balance and focus. Begin in a squatting position with your feet hip-width apart and your hands placed flat on the floor in front of you. Spread your fingers wide for stability. Bend your elbows slightly, lean forward, and place your knees on the backs of your upper arms. Engage your core and lift your feet off the ground, balancing on your hands. Keep your gaze forward and hold the position for a few breaths.



Fig 27: Bakasana

2. HANUMANASANA

Hanumanasana (Monkey Pose) is a deep split that requires flexibility in the hips, hamstrings, and groin. Start in a kneeling position and extend one leg forward, straightening it while keeping the other leg extended back. Slowly slide your hands to the front foot and lower your hips toward the floor.



Fig 27: Hanumanasana

3. EKAPADA RAJAKAPOTASANA

Ekapada Rajakapotasana (One-Legged King Pigeon Pose) is a deep hip opener and backbend that stretches the thighs, hips, and chest while improving flexibility and posture. Begin in a tabletop position, bringing one knee forward and placing it behind your wrist, with the foot extended towards the opposite hip. Stretch the other leg straight behind you. As you inhale, lift your chest, and on the exhale, reach back with one hand to hold the back foot, gently drawing it towards your head. Hold for 5–10 breaths, then switch sides. This pose releases tension in the hips, deepens backbend flexibility, and improves balance.



Fig 28: Ekapada Rajakapotasana

b. STANDING

1. VATAYANASANA

Vatayanasana (Horse Pose) is a seated pose that stretches the hips, groins, and thighs while improving flexibility and balance. Begin by sitting on the floor with your legs extended straight in front of you. Bend your knees and place the soles of your feet together, keeping the feet close to the body. Inhale, lengthen your spine, and exhale as you slowly lower your torso towards the floor, aiming to bring your chest toward the ground.

6.2 SHAT KRIYAS

The Shat Kriyas, also known as Shatkarma Kriyas, is a set of yogic cleansing practices that purify the internal body and restart the system. This ancient yogic cleanse purges the body of accumulated toxins and waste, creating a clean environment where positive thoughts flow and ordinary experiences feel electric.

Benefits: Strengthens the immune system, Improves the metabolism, Assists with weight loss Reduces stress, Promotes mind and body awareness.

1. JALANETI & SUTRANETI:

Neti Kriya is a yogic practice that purifies the nasal passages and bathes the sinuses using a special 'neti pot'. There are two types: Jal Neti and Sutra Neti. It helps prevent disease and clear blockages before pranayama or asana practice. Nasal hygiene is similar to dental hygiene for maintaining good health. Jalaneti is practiced using a neti pot, which is filled with warm water and salt to clear the nasal passages.

Benefits of Jalaneti: It can relieve asthmatic conditions and bronchitis. It can reduce upper respiratory issues like sore throats, tonsils and dry cough.

Benefits of Sutraneiti: Creates lightness in breathing as the air passages are cleared. It is especially effective when performed after Jal Neti. Improves ENT health. They are internally connected to each other and blockage in one can cause disturbances in the other two organs.

2. NOULI (ONLY FOR MEN)

Nauli can be practiced by both men and women, but traditionally, some yoga schools advise women to avoid it during pregnancy and menstruation, as it puts pressure on the abdomen and reproductive organs. Nauli exercises strengthen abdominal muscles, massage lower abdominal organs, regulate blood pressure, prevent diabetes, treat heartburn, and treat skin diseases.

3. SHEETKARMA KAPALABHATI

Sheetkrama Kapalabhati is one of the variations of Kapalabhati or the skull shining breathing technique. In Sheetkrama Kapalabhati, water is sucked in through the mouth and expelled through the nose. It is an excellent way to remove mucous from the nasal cavity, throat and the pharynx.

How to practice:

Start the Sheetkrama Kapalabhati practice by taking a glass of water, adding salt for nasal cavity cleansing. Curl the tongue to create a channel, suction, and hold the mouth with water. Bend your trunk forward, head tilted downwards, and nostrils pointing towards the floor.

Benefits: Sheetkrama Kapalabhati is a practice that purifies mucous from the nasal cavity and throat, removes wrinkles, and promotes good health. It removes Kapha Dosha, activates energy centers in the brain, and activates the Bindu Chakra, resulting in immortality and nectar flow.

COURSE OUTCOMES:

The student should be able to understand:

- The importance of fitness/sports in day-to-day life
- Benefits of Yoga on fitness and health
- Understand the importance of his/her responsibility towards the society.
- Analyze the environmental and societal problems/issues and will be able to design solutions for the same